



High Bandwidth Routers

D-link announced two new Wi-Fi routers, the Touch DIR-865 is a true dual band router with throughput of upto 450 Mbps while the Wireless N Pocket Router minimobile router is for people on the go

delivering 3D content to these screens. DirectTV and Foxtel, are just two providers reportedly getting ready to start broadcasting 3D in the United States as early as next year.

For all the movies that you love and were never made in 3D, the converting boxes that sprouted at CES can come to your rescue. JVC and Toshiba both showcased mechanisms through which a normal video stream could be converted to 3D. This practically solves the problem of 3D content creation, but how well this works across a range of movies remains to be seen. We wonder what these boxes would do with something like "The Lion King". Some media companies can probably do a better conversion at their labs, then release the content on DVDs, which is something that Sony announced it would get into. Sony also said that they could put a patch in the PS3 firmware that would make the console ready for 3D gaming, at 1080p resolution at that. That is double the output of the device in the same time, which is a pretty tall claim. LG rolled out their Optoma range of projectors, which is something for the home cinema enthusiasts who do not prefer screens. Unlike previous 3D projectors, these ones source the image information from the same lens. All of these technologies use the shutter model for the glasses, which means that the screen and the glasses have to be synchronised. A few glassless 3D screens were around, but these were nowhere near as effective or market ready as the ones that did use the glasses. Panasonic seems to be really intent on bringing 3D to every home, as it even rolled out a range of HD 3D camcorders for home



Samsung's ebook reader

use. There are two lenses, and two memory storage devices to capture and record the streams. Panasonic will start taking orders for these from April.

Kindle gets some competition

Though not a very popular category, it also had its share of limelight in this CES. It was started by Samsung which

Why it might not happen

- You cannot really relax in front of a television with those glasses on
- The frame of the Television restricts the effect of the 3D
- The novelty is not worth the investment
- Might work for gaming, but not for television
- The 3D experience can be nauseating to some

unveiled two new E-book readers with a 6 inch and a 10 inch display. Both of them ship with a stylus to scribble on the device while you read it. Sony's had an entire line-up of e-book readers, some of them with touchscreens and a downloadable applications. Spring also showed some innovation by adding a second, coloured screen for web access, to its E-book reader. Plastic Logic also showed an E-book which

was for "Mobile Professionals", known as the Que. This is still a category which has been dominated by the Amazon Kindle for long, and the entry of giants in this market benefits the consumer by competitive prices and greater variety.

Home wireless explores new territories

One element common to all the major trends at CES this year, from 3D TVs, to tablets to the superphones, were the wireless capabilities of these devices. A range of wireless technologies have matured, with open frequency radio and Wi-Fi being the most used. Blu-tooth and infra red took a back seat, as they do not offer the bandwidth for some of the applications. Around our homes, and in our pockets, we interface with a number of devices, PMPs, cameras, netbooks, television, and even the GPS devices in our vehicles. Manufacturers have begun to exploit the applications of wireless technologies only now, and we can expect to see a lot of these devices communicating to each other using invisible channels.

One buzzword that emerged was WHDI (Wireless Home

Digital Interface), which is a network of communication through which devices such as PMPs, Camcorders, and Laptops can interface with the televisions and home theatre set ups in a home. LG, Westinghouse and Celeno, all television manufacturers, showcased a range of products that could catch video content in a wireless manner. Celeno's demo installation involved a common box through which media content was streamed to a number of television screens in and around the house. Almost everyone already owns an HDTV, which is why the real numbers were seen in devices that acted as middlemen between a source of video content, as in the internet or a HTPC, and the television. Belkin had a range of switches that could stream wireless content from say a laptop, to a small attachment to the television itself. These switches had USB ports as well, if that was necessary. Belkin was one of the few manufacturers that could support 1080p video streaming, the best that most of the rest could do was stream at either a 1080i resolution, or at 720p. Intel used a technology called WiDi (Wireless Display), to stream across HD content through laptops which used their core i5 and i7 processors. Roku, Boxee and Kula were all services that connected directly to the internet for video content, delivered in a range of ways. Mediaroom 2.0 by Microsoft let's you save multimedia, stream to televisions, transfer the content wirelessly to PMPs, and even access the content over the cloud if necessary. Cydle's Mobile TV i30 works the other way around by streaming television